Victorian Water Trading

2024-25 Annual Report



VICTORIA State Government

Energy, Environment and Climate Action

Photo credit

The title page photo was taken by James Lauritz. It shows an aerial photo of the Glenmaggie Bridge over Lake Glenmaggie in Gippsland, Victoria.

We acknowledge and respect Victorian Traditional Owners as the original custodians of Victoria's land and waters, their unique ability to care for Country and deep spiritual connection to it.

We honour Elders past and present whose knowledge and wisdom has ensured the continuation of culture and traditional practices.

DEECA is committed to genuinely partnering with Victorian Traditional Owners and Victoria's Aboriginal community to progress their aspirations.



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1. About this report

The purpose of this report is to provide a record of water trade behaviour across the year in Victoria. It maintains continuity with annual water trading reports dating back to 2007-08.

Many terms and phrases have specific meanings in the context of Victoria's water market. You can learn more about the types of water rights that can be traded at Water Trading - Water Register. A water dictionary is also available for definitions of terms.

Section 4: *Additional tables and charts* presents supplementary data without written commentary and is provided as additional context to the analysis in this report.

This report is a streamlined version of what was released in previous annual trade reports. Unless otherwise stated, the data presented in this report comes from the Victorian Water Register. If you wish to explore more, the Victorian Water Register website has data available to view or download, or you can contact us on water.reporting@deeca.vic.gov.au.

2. 2024-25 overview

About the same allocation water traded The total volume of allocation water traded was 4,062 GL, about the same as the previous year.	**Higher allocation trade prices** Allocation prices were higher for most of the year in 2024-25 compared to the previous year.	**More water share transfers** About 118 GL of high and low-reliability water shares transferred ownership compared to 101 GL in the previous year.	**Take and use licence trade was about the same** More temporary trade in Take and Use licences, but less permanent trade compared to the previous year.

The southern Murray-Darling basin saw drying conditions in 2024-25, with total water availability falling somewhat in Victoria. At the same time there was a record volume of allocation trade (excluding environmental trade) for the fourth year in a row. Allocation trade prices were generally higher but more stable than the previous year.

3. 2024-25 Key trade statistics

Private allocation trade volume continued to grow

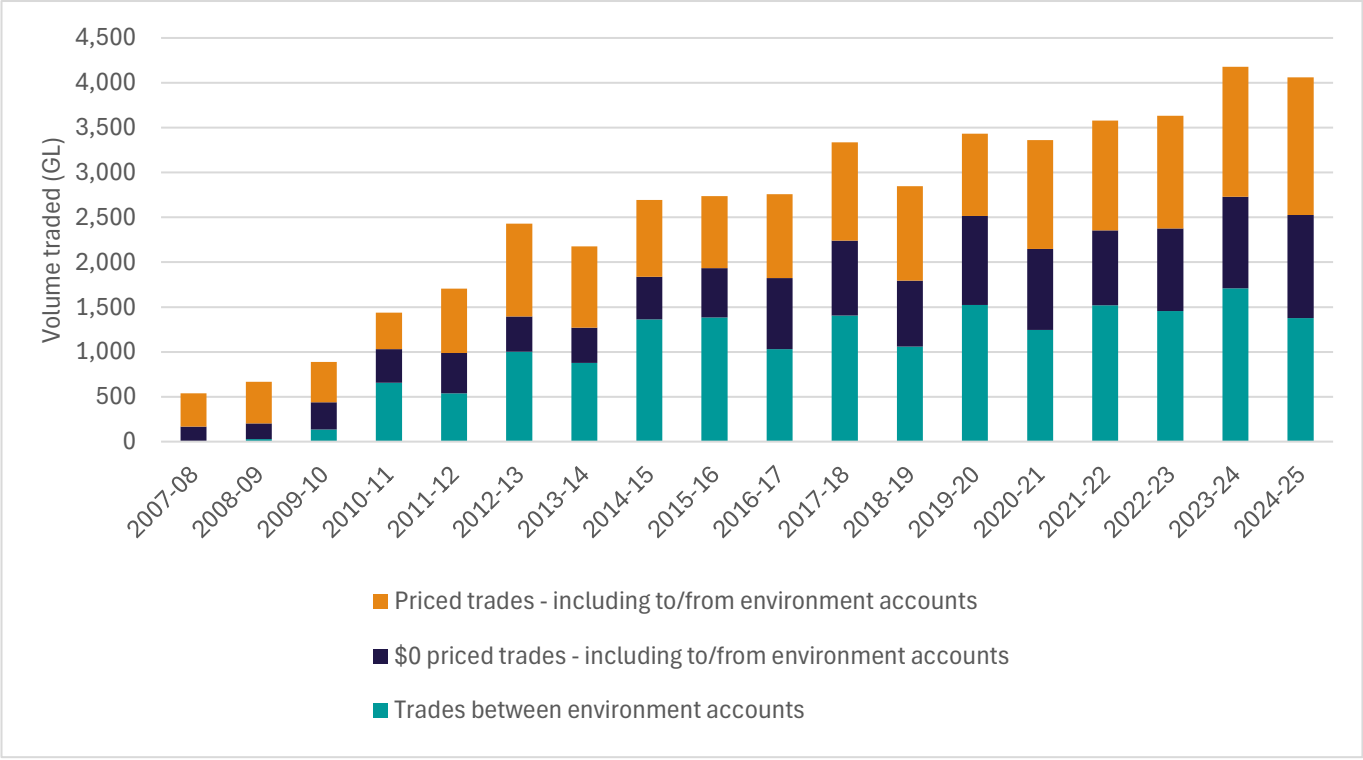
- 4,062 GL of allocation was traded in Victoria in 2024-25, the 2nd highest on record. This was slightly less than 4,177 GL in the previous year (Figure 1). The decrease in total trade was due to less environmental trade.

- Excluding environmental trade, there was more trade of all other priced and $0-priced allocation (2,684 GL) compared to the previous year (2,467 GL). This continues the long-term trend that has seen the scale of the Victorian allocation market consistently increase in size.
- Total allocation trade in Southern Victoria (19 GL) was higher than the previous year (10 GL), this is in contrast with declining trade volumes over the previous 6 years (Figure 8). Within the Southern systems, Werribee saw a doubling in volume traded (from 1.5 to 3 GL traded), and Thomson/Macalister saw much more priced trade occur compared to last year (Table 3).

Net trade out of Victoria has occurred for the 2nd year in a row, opposite the historical norm of net imports into Victoria

- Private (non-environmental) net trade to South Australia was about the same, but private net trade to NSW increased (Figure 7). Demand for irrigation in South Australia and drying conditions in 2024-25 for both NSW and South Australia may be contributing factors.
- The overall movement of private water within Victoria was similar to the previous year, with trade from Victorian Tributaries[1] to Zone 7 (138 GL) about the same the previous year (152 GL).
- The largest change in intervalley trade is an increase in private (non-environmental) exports to NSW, most notably from Zone 7 to NSW Murrumbidgee which had seen trade into Zone 7 of between 0 GL and 41 GL over the past 6 years but instead exported 12 GL to NSW Murrumbidgee in 2024-25 (Figure 11).

Figure 1: Allocation trade volume, whole of Victoria since 2007–08

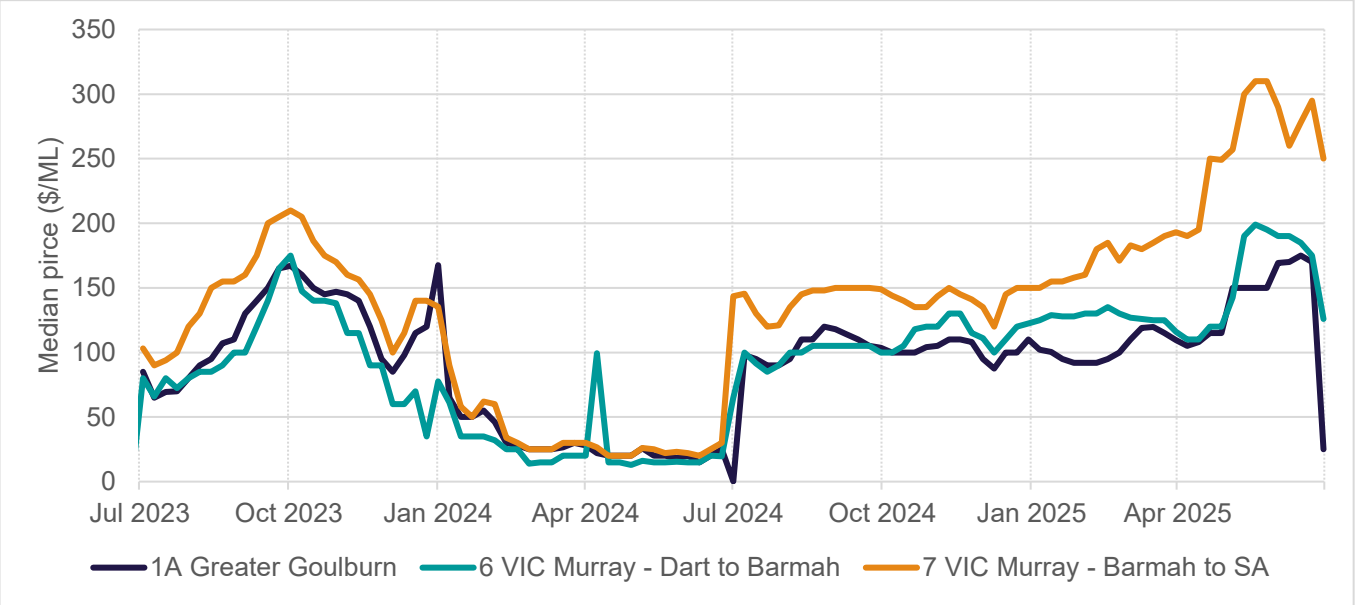


[1] 'Victorian tributaries' comprises all Victorian trading zones from 1A to 5B: that is, zones 1A (Greater Goulburn), 1B (Boort), 2 (Broken), 3 (Lower Goulburn), 4A (Campaspe – Eppalock to WWC), 4C (Lower Campaspe), 5A (Loddon - CC/Tull to LWP) and 5B (Bullarook).

Allocation prices were higher and consistent across most of the year

- Median allocation prices in Northern Victoria for 2024-25 started higher than the same time in the previous year ($100-150/ML compared to $80-100/ML respectively) (Figure 2).
- Where allocation prices peaked up to $200/ML in October then fell throughout 2023-24, prices in 2024-25 were broadly stable during the first half of the year, before rising in April and May 2025.
- In Southern Victoria, median allocation prices in the Werribee system increased to $400/ML which is a return to the long-term average. Thompson/Macalister saw allocation prices decrease slightly from $200/ML to $166/ML (Figure 10).

Figure 2: Allocation trade median price, weekly in zones 1A, 6, and 7, 2023-24 and 2024-25



Notes:

1. *$0-priced trades are not included in the median price calculations.*
2. *Isolated spikes away from the prevailing price may occur in some weeks with a small number of trades, for example due to forward contracts or private lease agreements.*

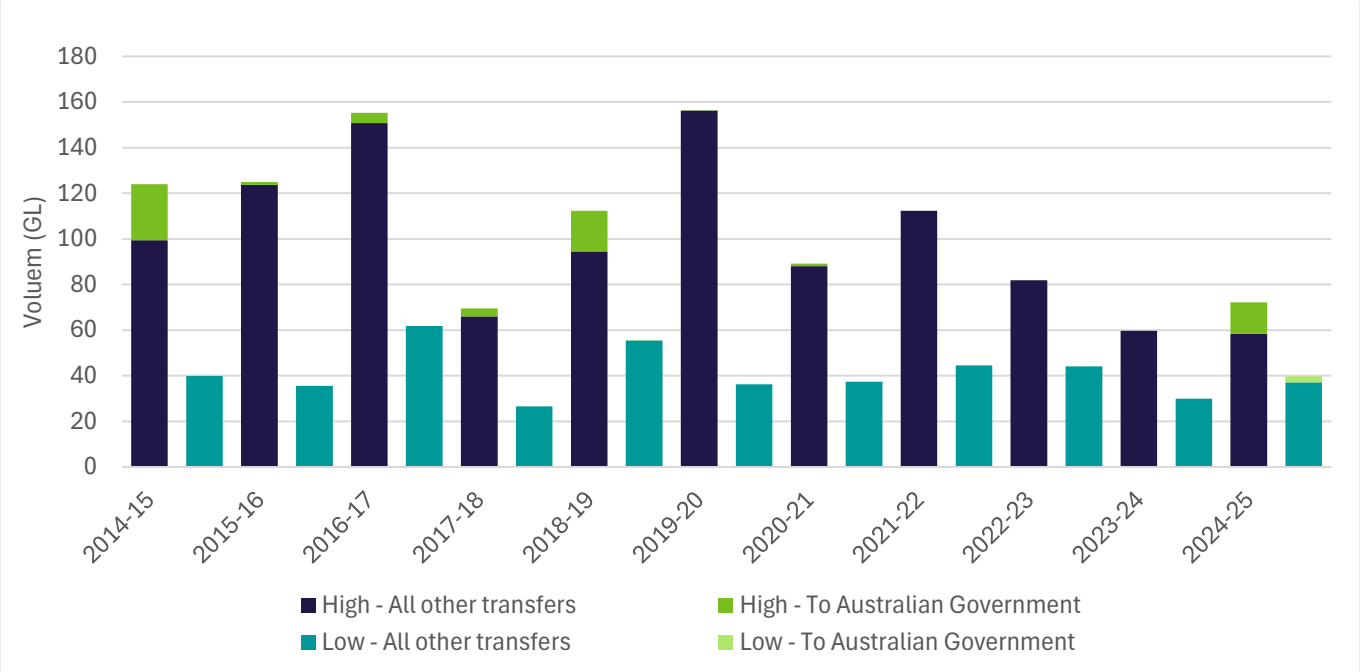
Commercial trade was the most common reason for trade by volume

- Standard commercial trades made up 43% of all non-environmental trade volume in 2024-25, similar to the 42% in the previous year (Table 4).
- The median price for trades as part of forward contracts fell slightly compared to the previous year from $140/ML to $125/ML across Northern Victoria, which is below the $135/ML for standard commercial trades.
- The volume of allocation traded under forward contacts and private lease agreements (not LTT) has increased each year since 2020-21 up to 159 GL in 2024-25. This growth indicates a growing number of irrigators are seeking to mitigate the risk of price fluctuations by utilising these arrangements.
- Unlike in June 2024, median prices of carry over parking arrangements in June 2025 ($20/ML) were much lower than standard commercial trades (between $150-225/ML) in Northern Victoria. Lower water availability compared to 2023-24 results in less unused water and more available carryover space, contributing to the lower carry over prices observed at the end of the 2024-25 (Figure 12 and Figure 13).

Water share trade volume was higher in Northern Victoria

- Northern Victoria saw 72 GL of high-reliability and 40 GL of low-reliability water shares transferred, which was about 15% higher than in 2022-23 (60 GL and 30 GL respectively) (Figure 3).
- The Australian Government commenced its Voluntary Water Purchase Program in July 2024 and water share transfers in 2024-25 included 14 GL of high-reliability and 3 GL of low-reliability purchased under the Murray-Darling Basin Plan. You can read more about Victoria's response to these buybacks at https://www.water.vic.gov.au/our-programs/murray-darling-basin/victorian-basin-committee and see up-to-date data at Australian Government purchases – Water Register.
- Southern Victoria saw 4 GL of high-reliability and 2 GL of low-reliability water share transfers in 2024-25, which was about half as much volume as in 2023-24 but across a similar number of transfers.
- Water share prices in 2024-25 were broadly similar to the previous year in Southern Victoria and 7 VIC Murray – Barmah to SA. There was a with a small decrease in the annual median price in 6 VIC Murray – Dart to Barmah to $4,250/ML from $4,500/ML in 2023-24, with a similarly change also in 1A Greater Goulburn (Figure 11).

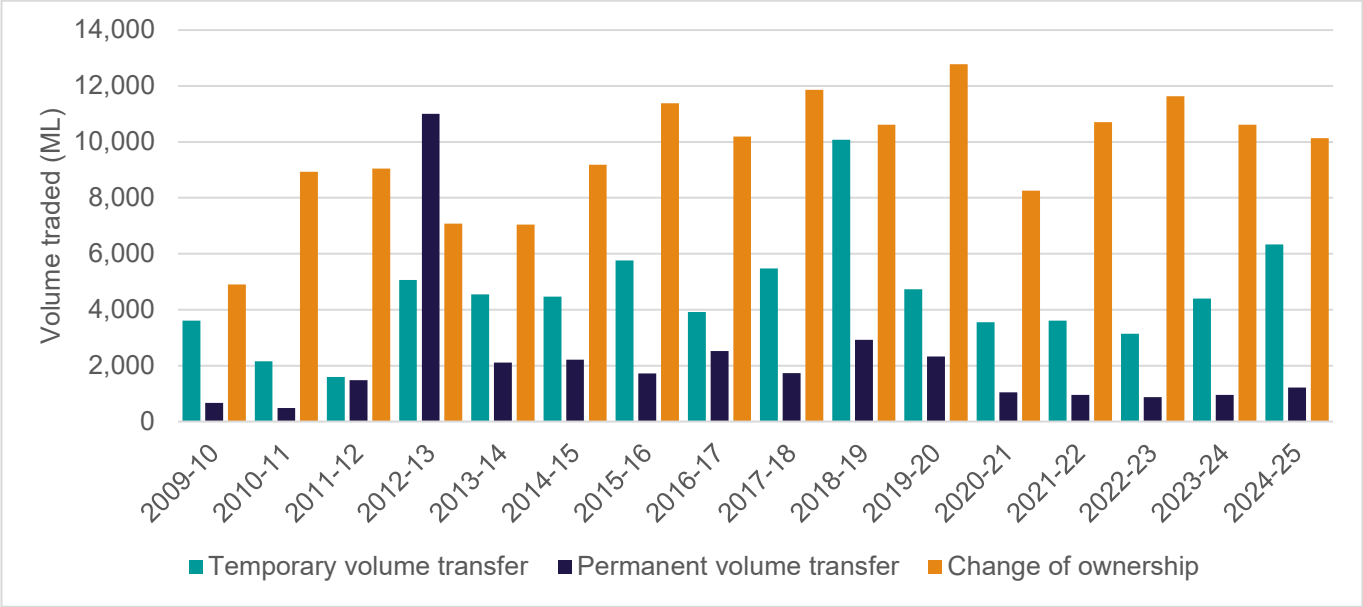
Figure 3: Water share transfers of ownership, northern Victoria



Temporary surface water take and use licence trade is higher

- There was an increase in temporary and permanent trade in 2024-25 compared to the previous year, with temporary trade volume being the highest since 2018-19. Trade as part of land transfers was about the same (Figure 4).
- Unlike other trade types, the largest volume of surface water take and use licence trade is recorded in Southern Victoria, this is in line with the volume of surface water take and use licences on issue being greatest in Southern Victoria.

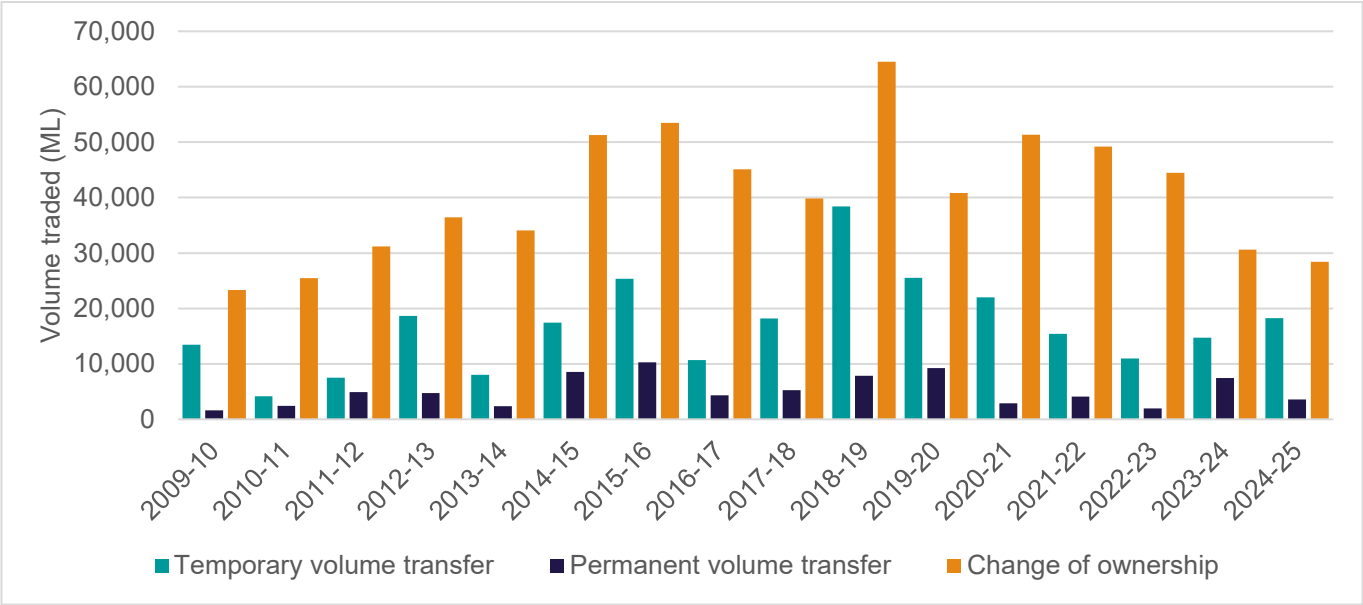
Figure 4: Take and use license trade in surface water, whole of Victoria



Temporary groundwater trade is up, but permanent transfers are down

- Temporary trade of groundwater take and use licences rose compared to the previous year, but the volume of permanent trade was about half (Figure 5).
- Northern Victoria was the most active, with Southern Victoria following. Western Victoria experienced the smallest number and volume of trades in all trade categories, the same as in previous years. This aligns with the total volume of groundwater entitlements on issue in each region.

Figure 5: Take and use license trade in groundwater, whole of Victoria



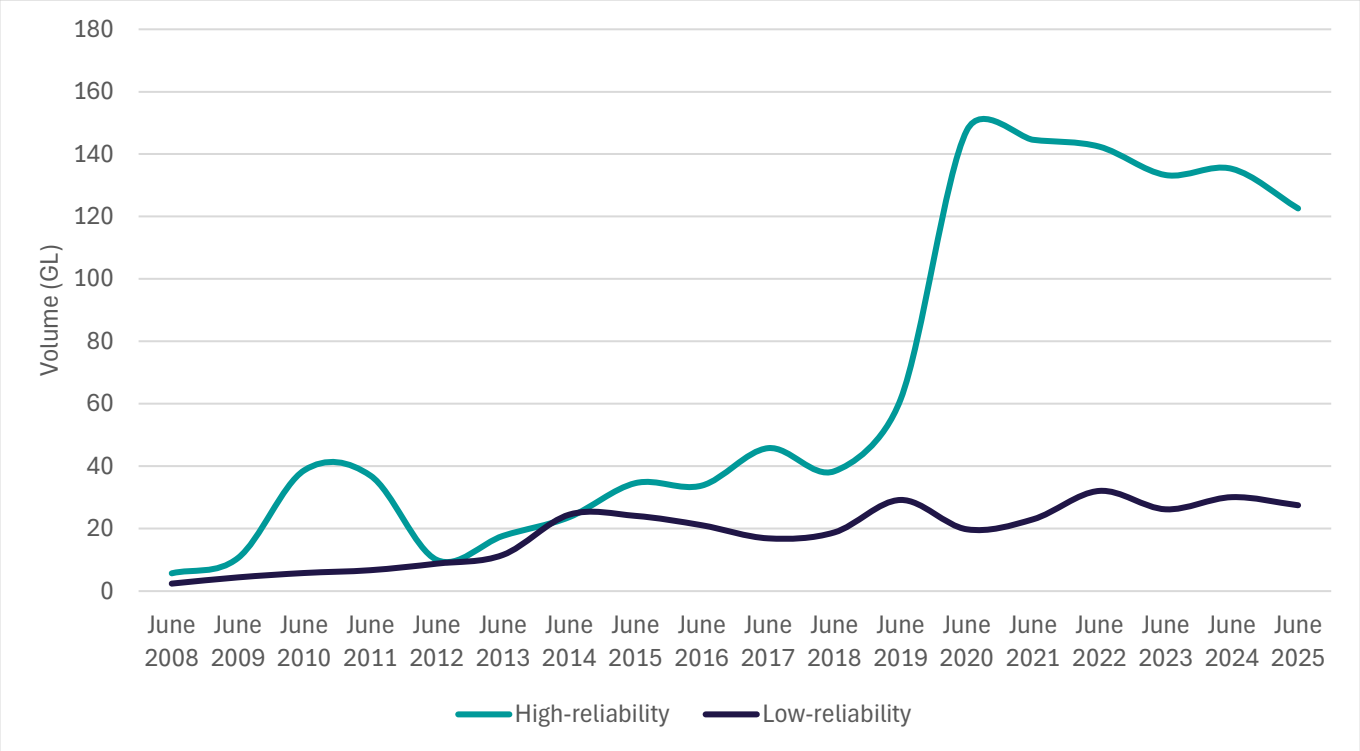
Extraction share trade is minimal

- In November 2023 the 'General Place of Take' framework passed into law establishing 'Extraction Share' in declared systems as a right to take water during water restrictions.
- There is not developed market for extraction share yet with only 17 market trades recorded in 2024-25. To learn more about place of take and extraction share see the water register website here: Place of take approvals - Water Register

Limited Term Transfers total active volume continues declining since 2019-20

- As some Limited Term Transfers (LTTs) expired the total volume of active LTTs on 30 June 2025 decreased by 9% to 123 GL and 28 GL for both high and low-reliability LTTs respectively (Figure 6).
- The volume of new LTTs recorded in 2024-25 was 13 GL, about the same as 15 GL in the previous year (Figure 16Figure 6).
- The volume of LTTs active in 2024-25 in Southern Victoria was unchanged from the previous year at 2 GL and 1 GL for high and low-reliability LTTs respectively.

Figure 6: Limited term transfers active at 30 June, whole of Victoria since 2007–08



Notes:

1. *The marked increase in 2019–20 in the LTTs recorded was mostly due to the restructuring of water assets between two companies.*

4. Additional tables and charts

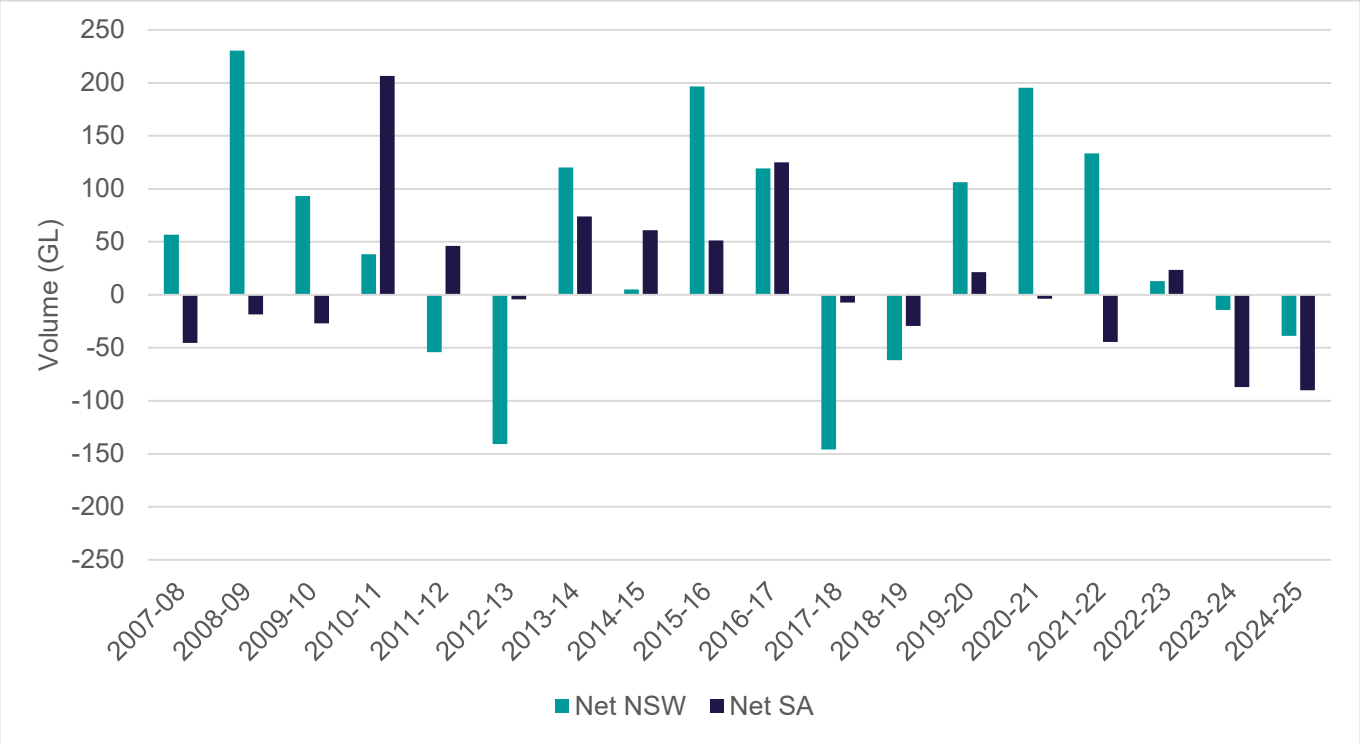
Table 1: Allocation trade summary

Trade type	2023-2024		2024-2025	
	Volume (ML)	Number of trades	Volume (ML)	Number of trades
Northern Victoria				
Priced trades	1,504,995	10,164	1,526,564	13,512
$0 priced trades	2,662,373	3,735	2,513,807	4,438
Northern Victoria subtotal	**4,167,368**	**13,899**	**4,040,371**	**17,950**
Southern Victoria				
Priced trades	1,132	27	7,996	124
$0 priced trades	8,990	110	11,133	190
Southern Victoria subtotal	**10,122**	**137**	**19,129**	**314**
Western Victoria				
Priced trades	0	0	0	0
$0 priced trades	0	0	2000	1
Western Victoria subtotal	**0**	**0**	**2,000**	**1**
Total	**4,177,490**	**14,036**	**4,061,500**	**18,265**

Table 2: Water share transfers of ownership, northern and southern Victoria

Water share type	2023-2024		2024-2025	
	Volume (ML)	Number of transfers	Volume (ML)	Number of transfers
High-reliability				
Northern Victoria	59,654	1,616	72,142	1,628
Southern Victoria	7,935	109	3,964	100
High-reliability subtotal	**67,589**	**1,725**	**76,106**	**1,728**
Low-reliability				
Northern Victoria	29,998	628	39,713	689
Southern Victoria	3,900	90	1,765	76
Low-reliability subtotal	**33,898**	**718**	**41,478**	**765**

Figure 7: Private net allocation trade volume, interstate by state



Notes:

1. *Positive volumes represent water imported into Victoria. Negative volumes represent water exported out of Victoria.*
2. *The volumes in this figure are including interstate tagged trade. Tagged trade is when water used in one trading zone is sourced from a different trading zone. Previous annual trade reports have not included tagged trade in this chart.*

Table 3: Allocation trade, southern Victoria

Trade type	2023-2024		2024-2025	
	Volume (ML)	Number of trades	Volume (ML)	Number of trades
Thomson/Macalister system				
Priced trades	781	16	6,760	88
$0 priced trades	7,826	74	9,347	116
Thomson/Macalister system subtotal	**8,607**	**90**	**16,107**	**204**
Werribee system				
Priced trades	351	11	1,236	36
$0 priced trades	1,164	36	1,786	74
Werribee system subtotal	**1,515**	**47**	**3,022**	**110**
Total	**10,122**	**137**	**19,129**	**314**

Figure 8: Allocation trade volume, southern Victoria, since 2008-2009

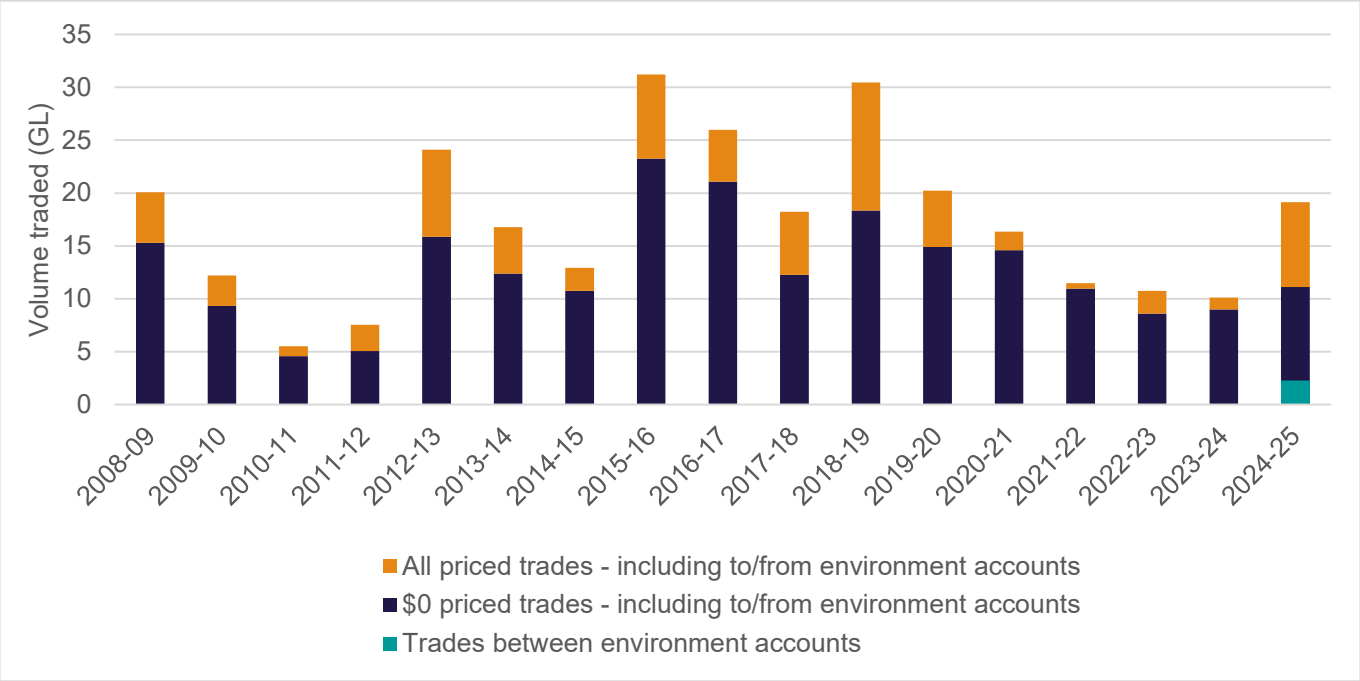
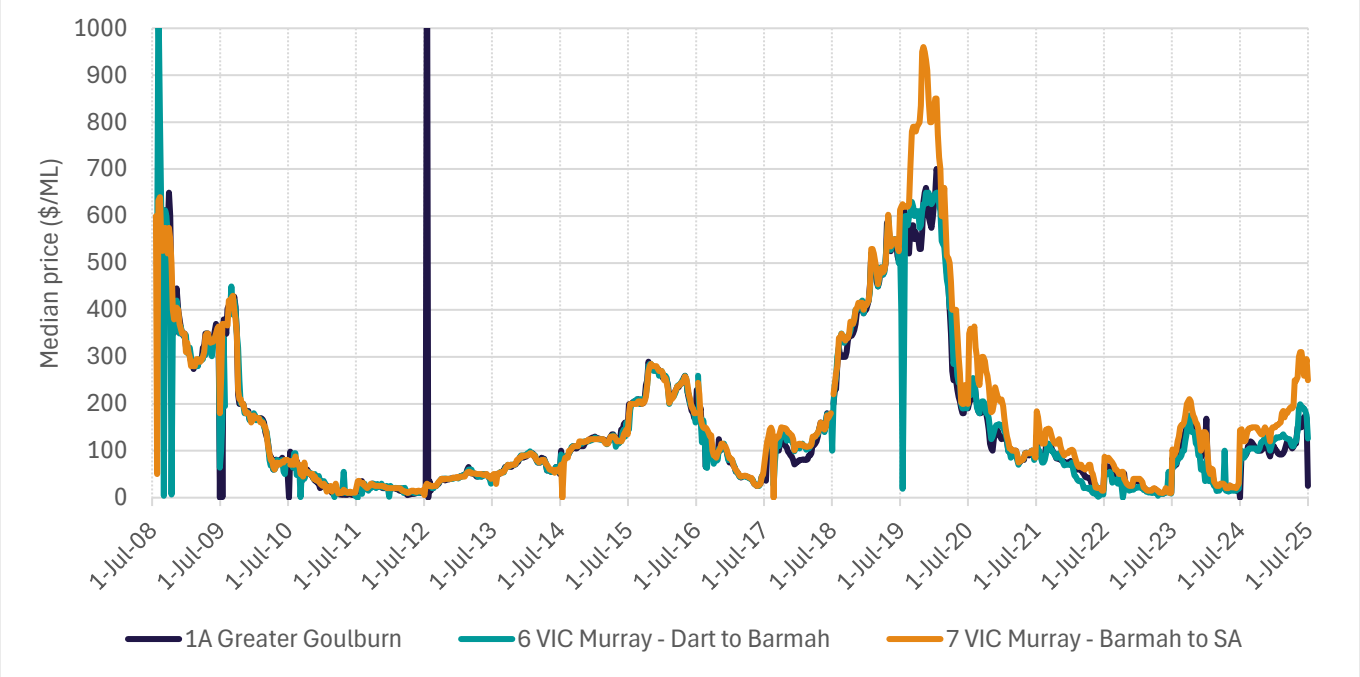


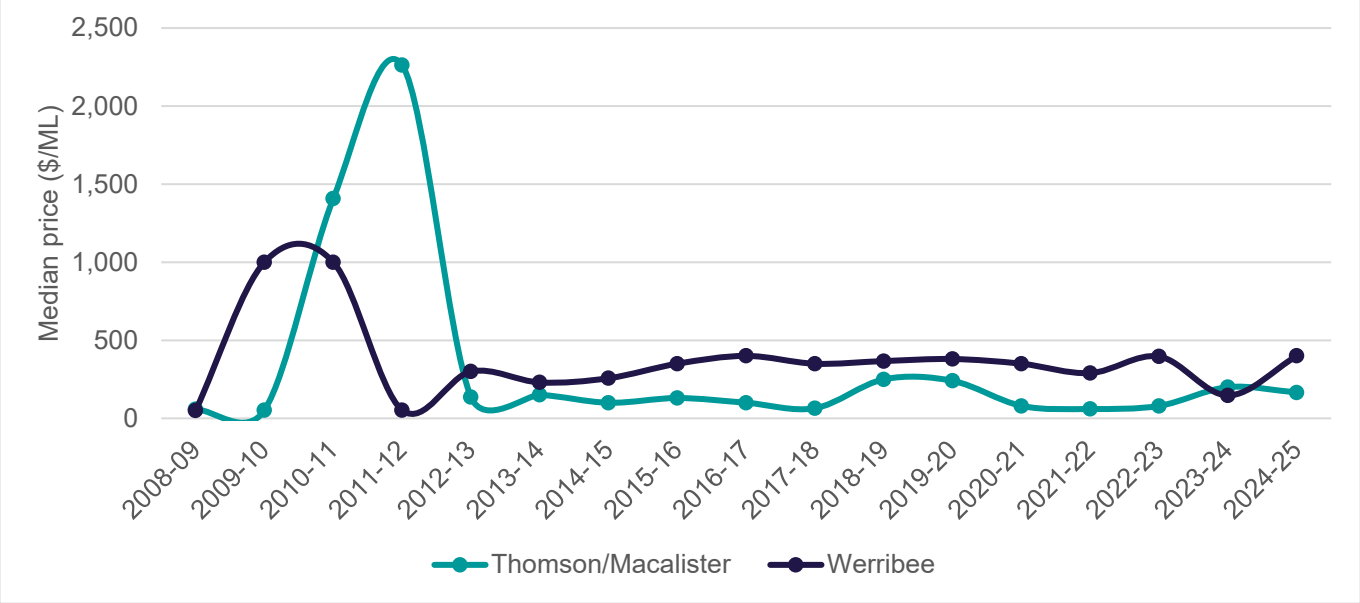
Figure 9: Allocation trade median price, weekly, zones 1A, 6, and 7, since 2008



Notes:

1. *$0-priced trades are not included in the median price calculations.*
2. *Isolated spikes away from the prevailing price may occur in some weeks with a small number of trades, for example due to forward contracts or private lease agreements.*

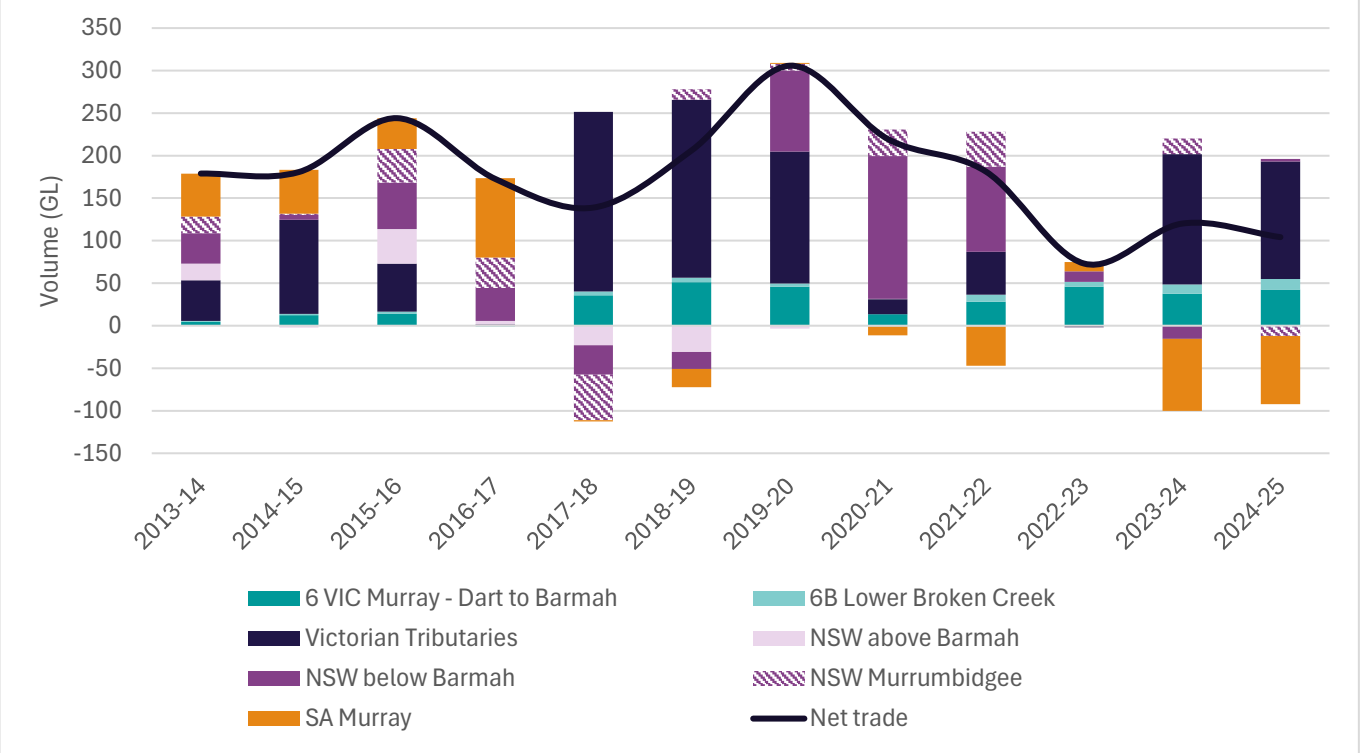
Figure 10: Allocation trade median price, southern Victoria since 2008–09



Notes:

1. *$0-priced trades are not included in the median price calculations.*

Figure 11: Net allocation trade and tagged use volume to zone 7 (Vic Murray – Barmah to SA)



Notes:

1. *This figure shows private accounts only.*
2. *Positive volumes represent water moving into zone 7. Negative volumes represent water moving out of zone 7.*
3. *'Victorian tributaries' comprises all trading zones from 1A to 5B: that is, zones 1A (Greater Goulburn), 1B (Boort), 2 (Broken), 3 (Lower Goulburn), 4A (Campaspe – Eppalock to WWC), 4C (Lower Campaspe), 5A (Loddon - CC/Tull to LWP) and 5B (Bullarook).*

Figure 12: Allocation trade price, by reasons for trade in zone 1A

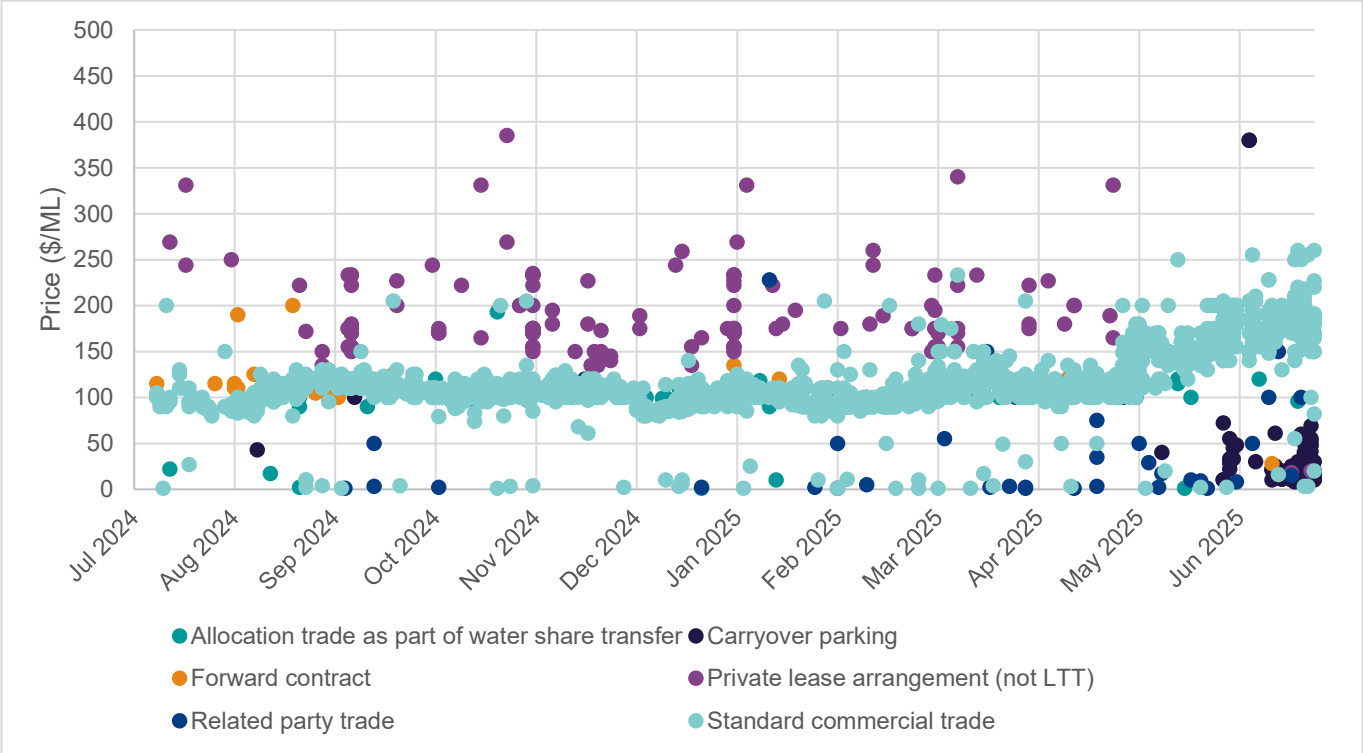


Figure 13: Allocation trade price, by reasons for trade in zone 7

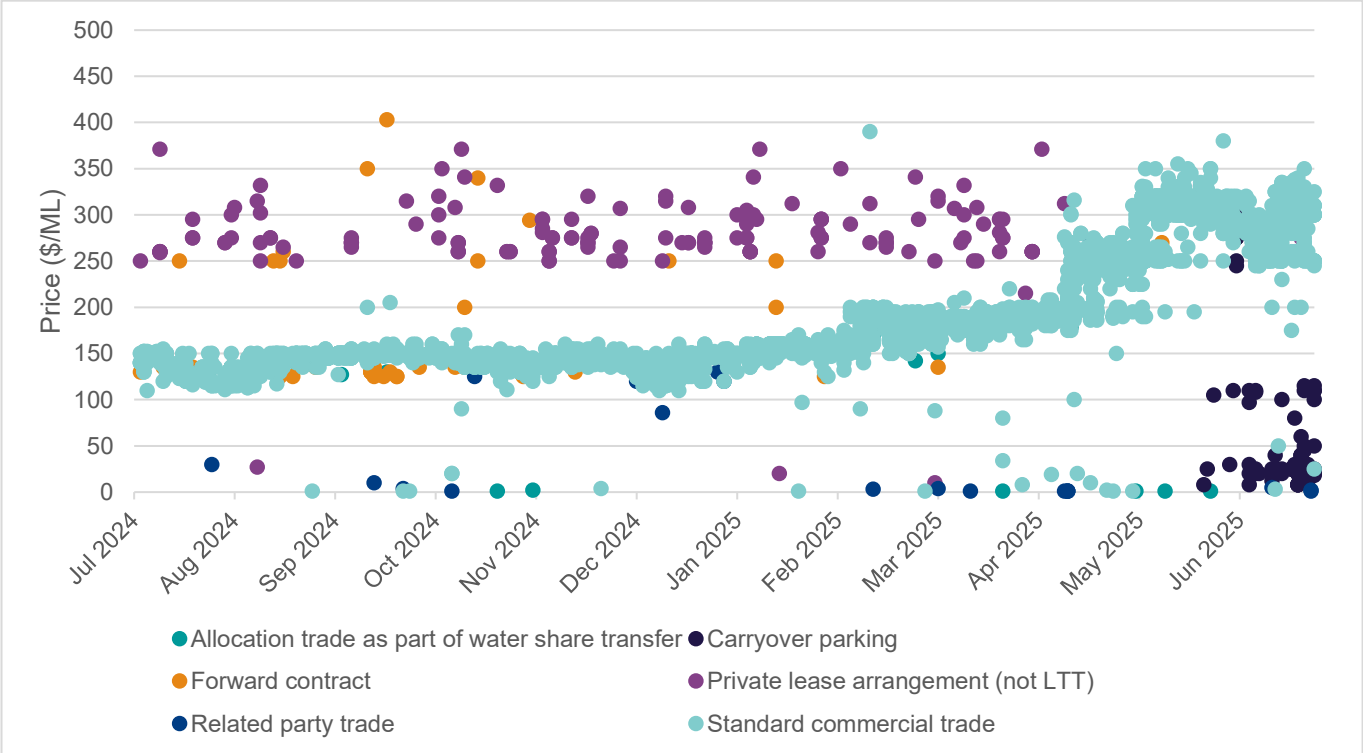


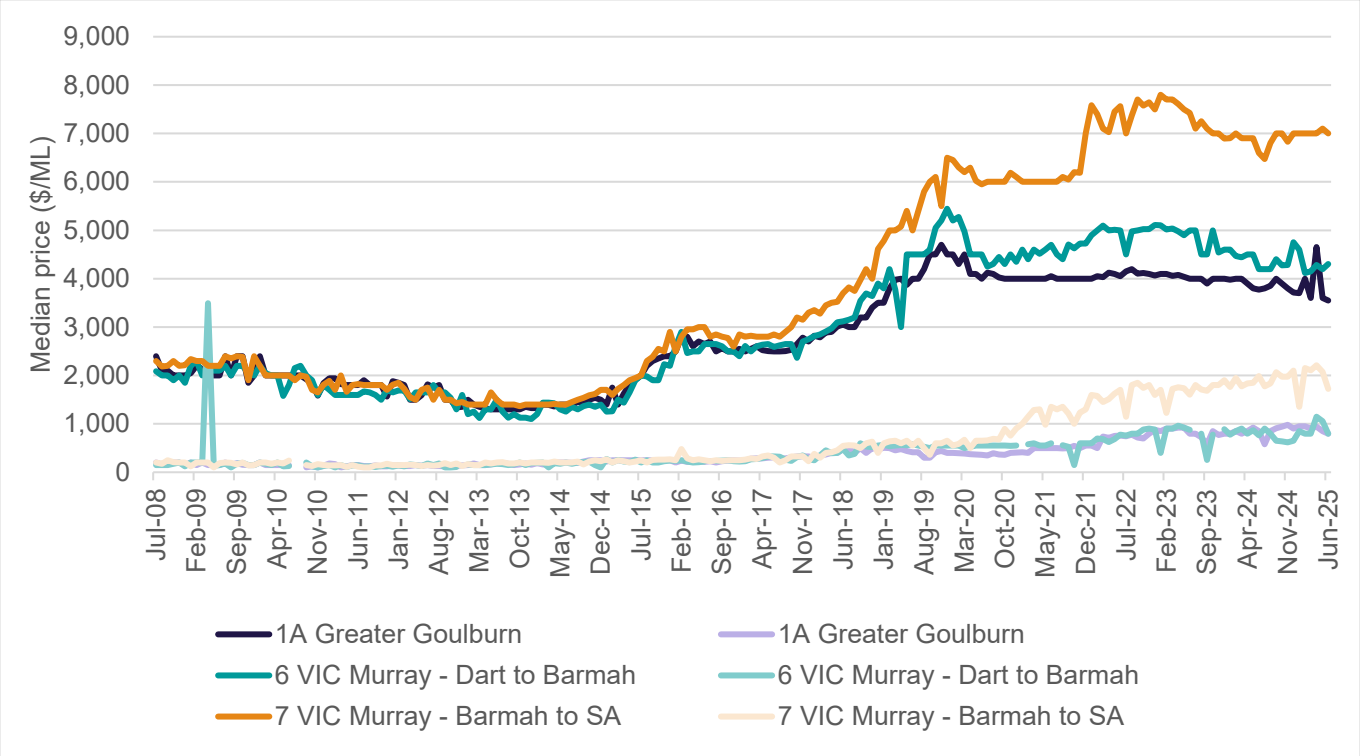
Table 4: Reasons for trade, whole of Victoria (excluding within environment)

Reason for trade	2023-2024		2024-2025	
	Volume (GL)	Number of trades	Volume (GL)	Number of trades
Standard commercial trade	1,029	8,239	1,165	11,668
Related party trade	867	2,506	864	3,097
Carryover parking	167	316	132	279
Carryover parking return	109	368	168	332
Private lease arrangement (not LTT)	68	389	76	361
Forward contract	54	102	83	150
Allocation trade as part of water share transfer	19	496	12	401
Other	14	81	22	115
Legacy	145	1,431	170	1,755
Total	**2,473**	**13,928**	**2,693**	**18,158**

Notes:

1. *This table excludes trades between environmental accounts.*
2. *'Legacy' type refers to trades processed manually by water corporations where no reason for trade was collected.*
3. *This document was republished in January 2026. The initial publication in December 2025 contained an error in Table 4 which has now been corrected. The previous version of Table 4 erroneously included within environment trade.*

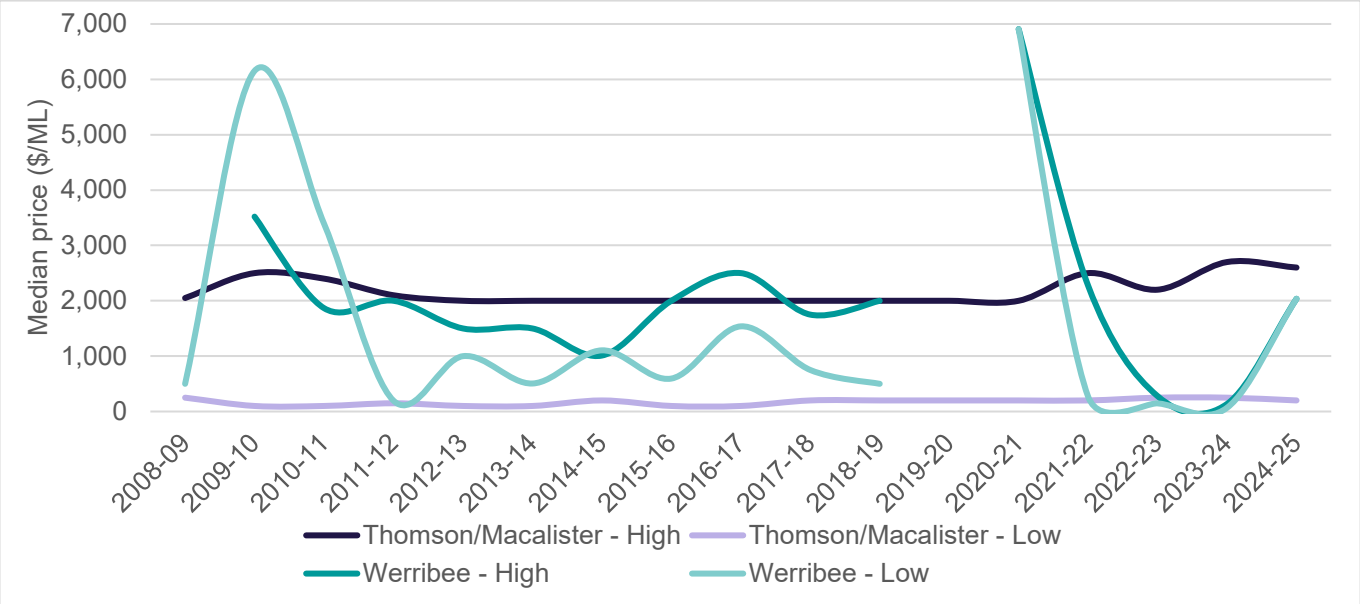
Figure 14: High and low-reliability water share transfers of ownership monthly median price, zones 1A, 6, and 7, since 2008



Notes:

1. *$0-priced trades are not included in the median price calculations.*

Figure 15: Water share transfers of ownership annual median price, Southern Victoria since 2008–09



Notes:

1. *$0-priced trades are not included in the median price calculations.*
2. *Southern Victoria conducts a limited number of water share transfers per month, because of this an annual median price is used in this chart.*

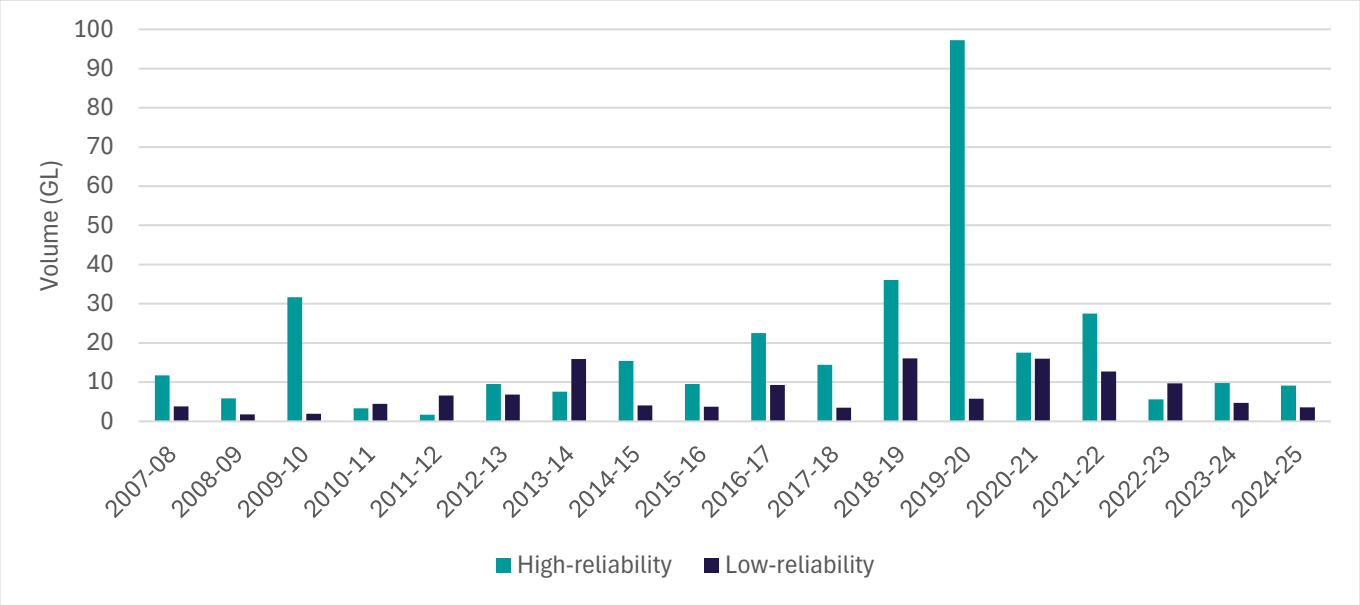
Table 5: Take and use license trade in surface water

Region	Temporary trade		Permanent trade (not as part of a land transfer)		Trade as part of a land transfer	
	Volume (ML)	Number of trades	Volume (ML)	Number of trades	Volume (ML)	Number of trades
Northern Victoria	2,366	99	598	39	3,765	177
Southern Victoria	3,973	103	624	22	6,170	178
Western Victoria	0	0	0	0	194	17
Total 2024-25	**6,338**	**202**	**1,222**	**61**	**10,129**	**372**
Total 2023-24	4,394	119	958	70	10,620	378

Table 6: Take and use license trade in groundwater

Region	Temporary trade		Permanent trade (not as part of a land transfer)		Trade as part of a land transfer	
	Volume (ML)	Number of trades	Volume (ML)	Number of trades	Volume (ML)	Number of trades
Northern Victoria	10,548	85	2,605	23	17,826	120
Southern Victoria	6,005	103	804	19	10,219	115
Western Victoria	1,693	13	150	1	344	4
Total 2024-25	**18,246**	**201**	**3,559**	**43**	**28,390**	**239**
Total 2023-24	14,748	128	7,425	68	30,618	251

Figure 16: Limited term transfer applications recorded, whole of Victoria since 2007–08



Notes:

1. *The marked increase in 2019–20 in the LTTs recorded was mostly due to the restructuring of water assets between two companies.*

Table 7: Allocation trades processing times, 2024-25

Trade	Number of trades processed	Performance	Standard
With South Australia. (Performance = % processed within 20 business days)	623	98%	90%
With New South Wales. (Performance = % processed within 10 business days)	943	99%	90%
Within Victoria. (Performance = % processed within 5 business days)	17,624	98%	90%

Table 8: Water share transfer processing times, 2024-25

Trade	Number of trades processed	Performance	Standard
Approvals. (Performance = % registered within 20 business days)	2,691	99%	90%
Registrations. (Performance = % registered within 10 business days)	2,629	100%	90%

Notes:

1. *'Approvals' refer to Water Corporation approvals to transfer a water share.*
2. *'Registrations' refer to transfers legally recorded in the Victorian Water Register by the Water Registrar.*

Table 9: Total allocation trade in northern Victoria (excluding environmental trade), 2024-25

		Buyer trading zone source volume (ML)																	
		1A Greater Goulburn	1B Boort	2 Broken	3 Lower Goulburn	4A Campaspe - Eppalock to WWC	4C Lower Campaspe	5A Loddon - CC/Tull to LWP	5B Bullarook	6 VIC Murray - Dart to Barmah	6B Lower Broken Creek	7 VIC Murray - Barmah to SA	9A Ovens	9B King	10 NSW Murr U/S Barmah Choke	11 NSW Murr D/S Barmah Choke	12 South Australian Murray	13 Murrumbidgee	**Total Volume (ML)**	**Total number of trades**
Seller trading zone source volume (ML)	1A Greater Goulburn	803,333	62,863	657	7,652	2,817	725	3,322		345	245	136,474							**1,018,433**	**6,856**
	1B Boort	59,264	12,890		900			410				2,593							**76,057**	**341**
	2 Broken	5,482		1,046															**6,528**	**110**
	3 Lower Goulburn	17,180	600		2,436	772		20				421							**21,428**	**201**
	4A Campaspe - Eppalock to WWC	18,261	1,669		832	5,758	71	328											**26,919**	**182**
	4C Lower Campaspe	1,291			66	38	14												**1,409**	**29**
	5A Loddon - CC/Tull to LWP	8,453	721					5,650											**14,824**	**193**
	5B Bullarook								63										**63**	**5**
	6 VIC Murray - Dart to Barmah	5								204,068	282	42,699			43,879				**290,934**	**1,887**
	6B Lower Broken Creek	223								2,292	2,104	16,051				250	1,390	355	**22,664**	**262**
	7 VIC Murray - Barmah to SA	2,422	12					16		31	3,721	777,167				50,635	133,669	53,205	**1,020,879**	**7,029**
	9A Ovens												597						**597**	**11**
	9B King													759					**759**	**18**
	10 NSW Murr U/S Barmah Choke									14,512									**14,512**	**66**
	11 NSW Murr D/S Barmah Choke										29	52,744							**52,773**	**331**
	12 South Australian Murray	100						20			164	53,466							**53,750**	**182**
	13 Murrumbidgee											41,295							**41,295**	**119**
	14 Lower Darling											1,003							**1,003**	**9**
Total Volume (ML)		**916,014**	**78,755**	**1,703**	**11,886**	**9,384**	**810**	**9,766**	**63**	**221,249**	**6,545**	**1,123,912**	**597**	**759**	**43,879**	**50,885**	**135,059**	**53,561**	**2,664,825**	
Total number of trades		**7,057**	**358**	**32**	**86**	**77**	**9**	**131**	**5**	**1,709**	**113**	**7,450**	**11**	**18**	**140**	**154**	**393**	**88**		**17,831**

Notes:

1. *Blank values or missing entries indicate that no trade occurred for that combination of seller and buyer trading zones for this water year.*
2. *Does not include tagged trade.*
3. *This table excludes trade between environmental accounts.*

Version history

#	Notes	Author	Publish date
1.0	Report published	DEECA	19 December 2025
1.1	This document was republished in January 2026. The initial publication in December 2025 contained an error in Table 4 which has now been corrected.	DEECA	12 January 2026



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